

NEENA VARANASI

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin - Austin, TX

Expected 05/28

M.S. in Statistics, B.S. in Statistics and Data Science (4+1 Accelerated Program) - GPA: 3.98

Minor in Business & Public Policy | Certificate in Elements of Computing | Polymathic Scholar Honors Program

Relevant Coursework: Data Product Development, Advanced Statistical Methods, Databases, Probability, Machine Learning

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Statistical Packages: Python, SQL, R

Data & Analytics Tools: Pandas, NumPy, Power BI, Streamlit, Matplotlib, Seaborn

ML / AI: scikit-learn, PyTorch, NLTK, NLP, RAG pipelines, SVM classifiers, open-weight/local model deployment

Data Engineering & Platforms: Git, GitHub Actions (CI/CD), Red Hat OpenShift, Google Cloud Platform

EXPERIENCE

Department of Statistics & Data Science, Austin, TX

Aug 2026 – Present

Machine Learning Course Assistant

- Analyzed classroom presentation data by adapting local LLM summarization pipeline into a privacy-preserving analytics system, translating unstructured audio data into structured, actionable feedback for students and instructors.
- Deployed local ASR/LLM feedback pipeline on TACC's Lonestar6 supercomputer, ensuring privacy-preserving, on-premise processing of student data for IRB compliance.

IBM, Austin, TX

May 2026 – Aug 2026

Data Science Intern

- Conducted data analysis across 3+ data sources and 50+ products to build a Python-based order analysis dashboard, delivering product offering recommendations that cut reporting turnaround from one quarter to 10 minutes.
- Designed and automated a competitive pricing analysis pipeline (SQL-based data collection), directly informing data-driven pricing decisions for cross-functional stakeholders.

AstraZeneca, Coppel, TX

May 2025 – Dec 2025

Operations Data Science Intern

- Built and deployed a Streamlit scheduling tool for 10+ managers, saving 40 minutes per day and replacing a crash-prone Excel process.
- Delivered a Power BI dashboard with automated data pipelines and 3 semantic models, saving 7 hours per quarter and accelerating site-wide analytics.

Big Data in Biology Lab, Center for Biomedical Research Support, Austin, TX

Jan 2024 – Dec 2025

Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Developed SVM classifiers in Python and R to classify psychiatric disorders from brain-blood RNA-Seq data, achieving 90%+ biomarker detection accuracy.
- Presented findings at 3 research conferences, translating complex modeling methodology into clear insights for technical and non-technical audiences.

First Principles Dental Training, Austin, TX

Feb 2025 – May 2025

Software Engineer

- Deployed a GPT-4 chatbot using FastAPI and Pinecone, delivering sub-30-second responses across 13+ issue types in a production React iOS app.
- Designed a compact reference dataset for chatbot queries, reducing embedding token usage and improving retrieval accuracy in a RAG pipeline.

HONORS & AWARDS

- 1st Place & Best Insight (2025), 2nd Place & Best Visualization (2024) — Statewide American Statistical Association DataFest Competition
- Freshman Research Initiative Summer Fellowship — \$2,000 award for outstanding research potential